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October 30, 2026

Search Committee
Information Technology Services, Miami University
Re: Senior AI Solutions Engineer

Dear Search Committee,

I am applying for the Senior AI Solutions Engineer position at Miami University. For the past two years at George Mason University, my work has followed the path this role describes: sitting down with a partner who has a real problem, judging whether AI can help responsibly, and carrying the answer from a prototype to something people rely on.

Our partner was Fairfax County's 9-1-1 center. Instructors could not run enough role-play calls to train new call-takers, so we co-developed SHIELD, a platform where LLM agents simulate emergency calls and coach trainees (ACM WSDM '26). I supported testing sessions with the agency, built the application, and refined it from instructor feedback. For MATE-911 (IEEE PST 2026), we ran Llama 3.1 locally instead of sending sensitive data to a commercial API, and I led the guardrails and evaluation work that brought hallucinations down to 3.0%. That project showed me how much adoption depends on trust: being able to show a non-technical partner what the system does well, where it fails, and which controls are in place.

I have also worked on the enterprise side. At Carelon Global Solutions, I delivered an Azure OpenAI and LangChain assistant handling more than 15,000 daily member queries in a HIPAA-regulated environment, built OAuth 2.0-secured services, and set up monitoring that kept production models above 95% accuracy for a year. At GMU, I evaluated GPT-4, Claude, and Gemini side by side and wrote documentation and reproducibility standards that two follow-on studies adopted.

What draws me to Miami is the chance to do this at institutional scale: shared AI services, evaluation frameworks, and guardrails that every unit can use, and a community of practice that grows around them. I have not yet owned enterprise platform administration or charge-back models, and I am eager to build that experience with Miami's ITS team.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the chance to discuss how I can help Miami adopt AI practically and responsibly.

Sincerely,
Ritesh Somashekar